terrorism and if India undertook not to make further proposals to list Pakistani individuals and entities in the future. [5]

India recognized the play as tactics. Two important high-level visits took place from India to China in the first half of 2016, and both Indian dignitaries reportedly pressed the matter hard with the Chinese side. [6] They conveyed that it was difficult to comprehend why China had reservations over the leader of the JeM being included in the 1267 Sanctions when the JeM itself was a proscribed organization in the United Nations. They questioned China's claim that its position was 'objective' and 'just'. By doing this, India signalled that it would not downplay the matter this time round, and that it was legitimately a matter to be discussed bilaterally in spite of the Chinese claiming that it was a multilateral issue. China's offer to act as a communication channel between India and Pakistan was also seen in India as a ruse to divert attention away from China as the problem and, consequently, politely rebuffed. This new approach reflected a change in India's way of dealing with China as compared to the earlier period. However, as yet, in public, India neither singled out China nor did it engage in public polemics. The general feeling in India was that China need not be pushed into a corner.

In the second half of 2016, India began to mount pressure on the Chinese to lift the 'hold'. By then the equation between India and China had shifted as a result of the Chinese actions in spearheading the efforts to block the consensus on India's membership of the NSG at the Seoul meeting in June 2016. China's efforts became public knowledge. India decided that it was the right time to take a more assertive stand. In August 2016, when the two Foreign Ministers, Sushma Swaraj and Wang Yi, met, the Chinese as usual claimed that the listing of Masood Azhar was not a bilateral issue between India and China. It was a matter for the UN Sanctions Committee to